

Samuel Bates

AI Solutions Manager

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SUMMARY

AI Solutions Manager at DoorDash who builds production AI for support operations and teaches organizations to use it: a production AI support workspace, an outsourced support team working live cases inside it, and AI-adoption training that reached 800+ people. Came up through operations and EMT crisis response.

EXPERIENCE

DoorDash – AI Solutions Manager

October 2026 – Present | Tempe, AZ (hybrid)

- **Lead AI solutions for merchant-integration support:** have been consultative partner to 5 builders since September 2025 and their primary PR approver since February 2026, and own the AI support workspace agents use to diagnose integration cases.
- **Took the org's first outsourced support team live inside that workspace:** proved their access layer by layer, built a generated training kit with an automated verifier, ran configuration and training, and coach live cases against a resolution-time target.

DoorDash – Technical Integrations Associate

April 2025 – October 2026 | Tempe, AZ (hybrid)

- **Built an AI support workspace from prototype into a production platform:** an LLM copilot grounded by server-side retrieval over the support playbook, on a frontier model through the company AI gateway, with relays to other teams' agents.
- **Shipped two production data apps:** a React + Fastify + Snowflake merchant mapping engine, and a workforce dashboard **validated against the legacy system by an external operations lead.**
- **Ran the program that moved stores off a POS partner's sunsetting API,** keeping **nearly all at-risk merchant revenue, under budget:** scoped four ROI-modeled funding options, stood up a vendor pod and built the Snowflake dashboard that ran it.
- **Built and ran AI-adoption training reaching 800+ people** plus an org-wide learning series on building with AI; wrote the org's AI builder playbook. Recognized by Anthropic's Claude Code team as one of Claude Code's top users (2026).
- **200+ PRs merged in 2026, every one built with AI coding agents; reviewed 211 PRs from 33 authors.** 2x Merchant Services Excellence Award; promoted three times in four years.

DoorDash – Disaster Prevention Specialist

November 2023 – April 2025 | Tempe, AZ

- Handled executive-level merchant escalations (50+ cases a day) and led cross-functional incident response across engineering, operations and vendor teams; built reporting that cut recurrence.

DoorDash – Senior Specialist, Merchant Services

September 2022 – November 2023 | Tempe, AZ

- Scaled an integration-automation tool across POS providers, running partner discovery sessions to clear onboarding blockers.

AZ Pain Doctors – Lead Patient Care Coordinator

2019 – February 2020 | Glendale, AZ

- Recruited, onboarded and trained 16 coordinators; promoted to escalation management and redesigned the SOPs behind the bottlenecks.

City of Phoenix Fire Department – EMT / Behavioral Health Crisis Response Team Lead (volunteer)

2015 – 2020 | Phoenix, AZ

- Led a 12-person crisis-response team: high-stakes triage, real-time decisions and cross-agency coordination.
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PROJECTS

Public builder portfolio | github.com/desertcache

- **Starship Explorer:** a walkable Three.js starship built by a fleet of Claude Code agents under typed contracts and test gates (16 functional tests, 131 fps). **Answer Finder:** a 4 MB on-device embedding model that matches recruiter questions to approved answers, scored on blind held-out sets (81% right on the first answer). Also Samantha UI (React 19 + GLSL), Velvet (on-device Whisper speech-to-text) and AI Radio (Ollama + F5-TTS).
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EDUCATION

Western New Mexico University

Coursework toward B.S., Cell & Molecular Biology

Estrella Mountain Community College

NREMT-B (Emergency Medical Technician)

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, Python, SQL

Frontend / Backend: React 18/19, Node, Fastify, GraphQL, REST

AI: LLM copilots, retrieval (RAG), MCP, agent integration

Data / Enterprise: Snowflake, Salesforce Omni-Channel, enterprise search